

Nutrition Guidelines: General Information

Balanced eating

A balanced diet includes a variety of vegetables, fruits, whole grains, protein foods and healthy fats. Variety helps provide the vitamins, minerals and fibre the body needs.

Salt and sugar

Adults are generally advised to keep sodium below about 2,300 mg per day, which is roughly one teaspoon of table salt. Added sugars should be limited, especially in sugary drinks, sweets and highly processed snacks.

Body mass index (BMI)

BMI is a screening measure calculated from weight and height. For adults, a BMI of 18.5 to 24.9 is generally considered the healthy range, 25 to 29.9 overweight, and 30 or higher obesity. BMI does not measure body fat directly and is only one factor among many in assessing health.

Hydration and alcohol

Water is the best everyday drink. Alcohol, if consumed at all, should be limited, since heavy drinking raises blood pressure and increases many health risks.